

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-28 (report created: 2026-06-28)

Headline	Value
Title pick	Argentina (17.3%)
Most likely finalists	Argentina & France
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 8.7
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	10,000

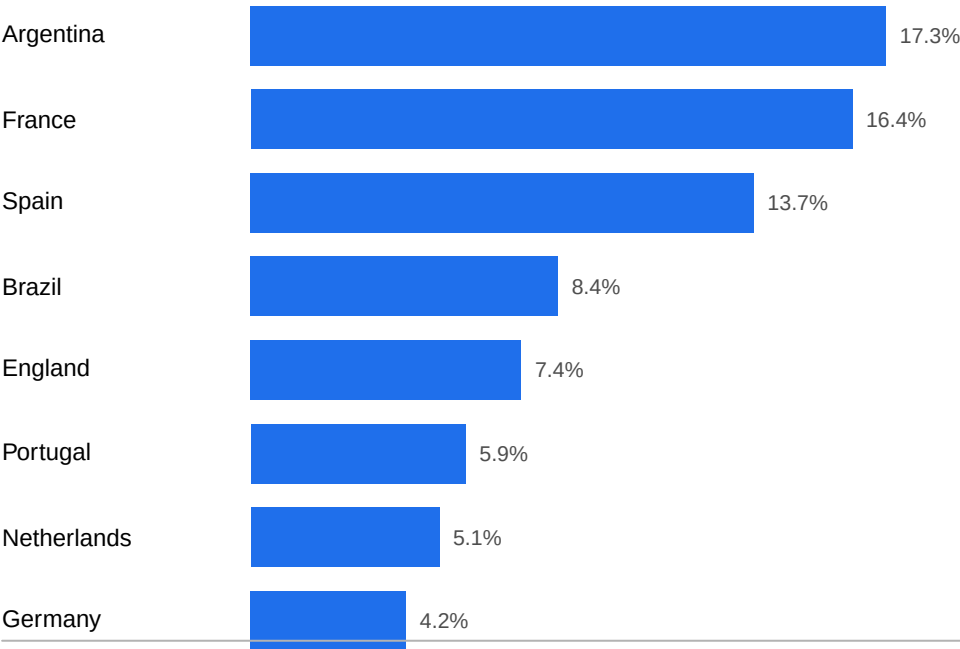
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-26 – probabilities from 10,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
Argentina	85%	67%	46%	28%	17.3%
France	82%	64%	44%	27%	16.4%
Spain	80%	57%	37%	24%	13.7%
Brazil	69%	44%	30%	16%	8.4%
England	78%	51%	26%	15%	7.4%
Portugal	63%	43%	22%	11%	5.9%
Netherlands	64%	42%	21%	10%	5.1%
Germany	71%	35%	21%	9%	4.2%
USA	74%	30%	15%	8%	3.4%
Mexico	61%	38%	18%	8%	3.2%
Belgium	71%	33%	14%	7%	2.6%
Colombia	64%	28%	11%	4%	1.9%
Canada	67%	32%	13%	5%	1.9%
Croatia	37%	21%	8%	3%	1.2%
Morocco	36%	19%	7%	3%	1.0%
Switzerland	56%	21%	7%	3%	0.8%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; Score = EV-optimal Scorito pick (max expected points)

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score	E[pts]
South Africa v Canada	Confirmed	Canada (67%)	Away win	1–2 (10%)	35
Mexico v Senegal	Confirmed	Mexico (61%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	32
Germany v Sweden	Confirmed	Germany (71%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	37
Brazil v Japan	Confirmed	Brazil (70%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	35
England v DR Congo	Confirmed	England (78%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)	41
Belgium v Algeria	Confirmed	Belgium (70%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	36
USA v Bosnia and Herzegovina	Confirmed	USA (74%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	39
Spain v Austria	Confirmed	Spain (80%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	42
Switzerland v Ecuador	Confirmed	Switzerland (56%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	27
Portugal v Croatia	Confirmed	Portugal (62%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	31
Australia v Egypt	Confirmed	Egypt (52%)	Away win	0–1 (10%)	25
Argentina v Cape Verde	Confirmed	Argentina (86%)	Home win	2–0 (13%)	47
France v Iran *	Projected	France (82%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	44
Cote d'Ivoire v Norway	Confirmed	Norway (58%)	Away win	1–2 (9%)	29
Colombia v Ghana	Confirmed	Colombia (63%)	Home win	1–0 (11%)	31
Netherlands v Morocco	Confirmed	Netherlands (63%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	32

* 1 tie(s) marked Projected use model-estimated participants (group stage not yet final

/ slot unconfirmed). Confirmed ties are locked from reported results. Update

knockout_bracket.csv as matchups are confirmed and re-run.

Top-Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection (Proj = goals; Scorito = expected game points)

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj	Scorito
Lionel Messi	Argentina	6	2.67	8.67	71.9
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.56	6.56	68.9
Jonathan David	Canada	4	1.67	5.67	38
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.57	5.57	40.4
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	1.38	5.38	29
Ousmane Dembele	France	4	1.16	5.16	31.3
Harry Kane	England	3	1.93	4.93	47.9
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.21	4.21	28.9
Riyad Mahrez	Algeria	3	0.44	3.44	8.5
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	2	1.36	3.36	33.6
Folarin Balogun	USA	2	1.16	3.16	26.4
Lamine Yamal	Spain	2	1.15	3.15	30.2

Scorito top-scorer picks for Round of 32 (position & stage weighted)

Player	Team	Pos	E[pts]
Alphonso Davies	Canada	DF	19.9
Lionel Messi	Argentina	FW	14.6
Jamal Musiala	Germany	MF	14.3
Kylian Mbappe	France	FW	13.6
Erling Haaland	Norway	FW	13.1
Jonathan David	Canada	FW	13
Harry Kane	England	FW	12.8
Christian Pulisic	USA	FW	11.2

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Submit the EV-optimal score per tie (max expected Scorito points), not the bare most-likely score -- the toto term dominates, so never pick a draw when a win is favoured. For top scorers, pick by Scorito value (goals x position x stage: a defender/keeper goal pays 4x a forward's), not raw goals. Model's title pick: Argentina (17.3%, worth 250 bonus pts).

Champion pick: Argentina (17.3%). Safe R16 backers: Argentina, France, Spain, England, USA, Germany.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.
2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions;
parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).
3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities,
with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.
4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by
how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.